TIPS & TRICKS

Resetting the root password

Have you ever forgotten your root password? Is your system set by a vendor who didn't provide you a root password? The following process will reset it.

When the Grub menu loads, use the keyboard to highlight your OS option and press the edit key, which is usually 'e'. There will be a line which usually starts with 'linux' or 'kernel' and ends with 'single' or 'quiet'.

Navigate to the line and click the *edit* key. At its end, just add the following command:

```
init=/bin/sh
```

Now click on 'Enter' and then the key to boot up the system, which is usually 'ctrl+x' or 'b'. You will be logged in as root in 'Text mode'. The file in which the password is saved would most probably be in read-only mode. To change it to read-write mode, use the following command:

```
sh# mount -o remount ,rw /
```

Now you can change the password using the 'passwd' command:

```
sh# passwd
Changing password for root.
Enter new UNIX password:
Retypr new UNIX password:
passwd: password updated successfully
sh#
```

There you go. The password has been changed.

—Sajin M. Prasad,
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Protect your valuable files

The *chattr* attribute is used to stop accidental deletion of files and folders. You cannot delete files secured via *chattr* even if you have full permission over files. Even *root* cannot delete files that have the *chattr* command.

To use this command, follow the steps shown below:

```
#cat > test This test file
#chmod 777 test
#chattr +i test
```

...and then try to delete a test file:

```
#rm -fr test (not allow)
#mv test (not allow)
```

If you want to remove permission, run the following command:

```
#chattr -i test
```

—Anshoo Kumar Verma,
anshooverma@expressindia.com

Find your public IP address with *dig*

Sites like *whatismyip.com* give you the Internet-facing IP address. This trick shows the outgoing IP address from the command line with the DNS *dig* utility:

```
#dig +short myip.opendns.com @resolver1.opendns.com
```

– Sani Abhilash,
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Avoid auto updation of the '/etc/resolve.conf' file in RedHat GNU/Linux

In RedHat GNU/Linux, the */etc/resolve.conf* file is used to configure the DNS resolver library. If you edit the file manually, then after each reboot cycle or after restarting the network service this file will get overwritten. We can override this behaviour by modifying network configuration. To avoid auto updation of */etc/resolve.conf* just add the following entry in the */etc/sysconfig/network-scripts/ifcfg-eth<NUMBER>* file:

```
PEERDNS=no
```